

Atom 1.19 text editor gets official with enhanced responsiveness

Atom has announced the release of the next version of its text editor. Debuted as Atom 1.19, the new open source text editor update comes with an upgrade to Electron 1.6.9. The notable change in Atom 1.19 is the improved responsiveness and memory usage. The integration of a native C++ text buffer has helped to smoothen the overall performance and operations of the text editor. Also, the key feature of Git and GitHub integration, which was introduced in Atom 1.18, has been improved with new tweaks in version 1.19.



Ian Olsen, the developer behind Atom, said that the improvements in Atom 1.19 are the new steps in the 'continued drive' to deliver a fluent experience for large and small files. Large files consume less memory in Atom 1.19. In the same way, file saving in the latest Atom version happens asynchronously without blocking the UI.

Atom 1.19 comes with a full rewrite of the text editor's rendering layer. This version has restored the ability to return focus to the centre. There is also an optimised native buffer search implementation that removes trailing whitespaces. The new text editor version also comes with the 'showLineNumbers' option set to false, by default. Atom follows the tradition of pushing the stable release along with the next beta version, and has released Atom 1.20 beta for public testing. The beta release offers better support for Git integration. Olsen has added a new API that can be used for observing dock visibility, along with fixes for PHP grammar support.

RaspAnd OS now brings Google Play support to Raspberry Pi 3

RaspAnd, the popular distribution for Raspberry Pi devices, has received a new build. Debuted as the RaspAnd Build 170805, the new version comes with Android 7.1.2 Nougat and includes Google Play support.



RaspAnd developer Arne Exton has released the new version. Exton has ported Google Play Services to enable easy app installations, as well as provided users with a pre-installed Google Apps package that comes with apps such as Chrome, Google Play Games, Gmail and YouTube. The team has also worked on improving the video performance in this version.

Along with providing extensive Google Play integration, the new RaspAnd OS has addressed the screen flickering issue that was reported in the previous versions. The latest release also includes Kodi 17.3 media centre, and apps such as Spotify TV, ES File Explorer and Aptoide TV.

RaspAnd Nougat build 170805 is available for existing users as a free update. New users need to purchase an image for US\$ 9 and install it on their machines using an SD card. You can use the Win32 disk manager utility or the GNU/Linux operating system.

The new RaspAnd build is specifically designed for Raspberry Pi 3 systems. Due to some higher resource requirements, the distribution is not compatible with previous Raspberry Pi models.

Google's Deeplearn.js brings machine learning to the Chrome browser

Google has developed an open source library called Deeplearn.js to enable an integrated machine learning experience on Chrome. The library helps to train



neural networks without requiring any app installations. It exploits WebGL to perform computations on a GPU level.

"There are many reasons to bring machine learning (ML) into the browser. A client-side ML library can be a platform for interactive explanations, rapid prototyping and visualisation, and even for offline computation," Google's Big Picture team, comprising software engineers Nikhil Thorat and Daniel Smilkov, wrote in a blog post.

Google claims that the library gets past the speed limits of JavaScript. The structure of Deeplearn.js is similar to the TensorFlow library and NumPy. Both these Python-based scientific computing packages are widely used in various machine learning applications. Deeplearn.js comes with options for exporting weights from TensorFlow checkpoints. Authors can even import TensorFlow components into the Deeplearn.js interface. Additionally, developers have the option to use the library with JavaScript.

You can find the initial list of Deeplearn.js demo projects on its official website. The Deeplearn.js code is available for access in a GitHub repository.

Microsoft brings Linux to Windows Server

Microsoft has released its second Insider preview build for Windows Server 2016. The new version, debuted as Windows Server Insider Build 16257, enables Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL) to offer distributions such as Ubuntu and OpenSUSE to the proprietary server platform.